

Chapter 3

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Occupational Exploration Worksheet: Matching Your Interests, Skills, and Values

Instructions: Work through each section step-by-step. Be honest and reflective in your responses—there are no right or wrong answers. Use the provided spaces to jot down thoughts, and refer to Chapter 3 for detailed guidance on tools like O*NET, BLS.gov, or Holland Codes.

Section 1: Self-Reflection and Interest Mapping

Goal: Identify your traits, interests, and values to guide your career search and set a foundation for matching careers to who you are.

- **Personal Traits and Preferences (5-10 minutes):** Write down 2-3 key traits or preferences about yourself that could influence your career choice. Examples: "I love working with people," "I enjoy solving complex problems," or "I value flexible hours."
 - Trait/Preference 1: _____
 - Trait/Preference 2: _____
 - Trait/Preference 3: _____
- **Interest Areas (5-10 minutes):** List 2-3 activities or topics you're passionate about or curious to explore in a career. Examples: "Technology and coding," "Helping others through education," or "Outdoor work and nature."
 - Interest 1: _____
 - Interest 2: _____
 - Interest 3: _____
- **Values in Work (5 minutes):** List 2-3 values that are important to you in a career. Examples: "Work-life balance," "Making a positive impact," or "Financial stability."
 - Value 1: _____
 - Value 2: _____
 - Value 3: _____
- **Quick Reflection (5 minutes):** How do you think these traits, interests, and values might connect to a career? Write a short sentence or two. Example: "My love for helping people and value for impact could point me toward teaching or counseling."
 - Reflection: _____

Section 2: Online Career Assessment Insights

Goal: Use online tools like Holland Codes (RIASEC) to identify career categories that match your personality and interests, providing a starting point for exploration.

- **Take an Assessment (20-30 minutes):** Access a free Holland Code test (or similar assessment) on sites like MyNextMove.org, Truity.com, or CareerExplorer.com. Complete the quiz and record your results below.
 - My Holland Code (e.g., “SAE” for Social-Artistic-Enterprising): _____
 - Brief Description of My Code (e.g., “Social types like helping people”): _____
- **Suggested Careers (10 minutes):** List 3 careers suggested by your assessment results that interest you. If none stand out, pick ones to explore further for learning purposes.
 - Career 1: _____
 - Career 2: _____
 - Career 3: _____
- **Initial Thoughts (5 minutes):** Which of these careers feels most aligned with your traits, interests, or values from Section 1? Why? Write 1-2 sentences.
 - Thoughts: _____

Section 3: List of Potential Careers

Goal: Identify occupations to research based on assessments, personal interests, or curiosity.

Instructions (5 minutes): Write down at least 3-5 occupations that interest you based on your research, online career assessment results, or personal reflection. These will be explored in detail in the next section.

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____ (optional)
- _____ (optional)

Section 4: Detailed Career Information and Comparison Chart

Goal: Research and record detailed information about each occupation, then compare them to evaluate alignment with your profile.

Instructions (30-60 minutes per career, can be split over days): Use resources like O*NET Online (onetonline.org), BLS.gov, CareerOneStop.org, or LinkedIn to gather information on each career. Fill in the table below for at least 3 careers (add rows for additional careers if desired). Rate “Personal Fit” and “Practicality” on a scale of 1-5 (5 being the best). Use this chart to spot which careers stand out or need more exploration.

Occupation	Job Tasks (What you do daily)	Working Conditions (Environment, hours, physical demands)	Salary & Benefits (Average salary, benefits, job outlook)	Required Qualifications (Degrees, certifications, skills)	Growth Potential (Future-Proof? % growth from BLS if available)	How It Matches My Interests, Skills, & Values (Personal Fit 1-5)	Practicality (Feasibility based on education, salary needs 1-5)
● 1.							

• 2.							
• 3.							
• 4.							
• 5.							

Occupation

Job Tasks (What you do daily)

Working Conditions (Environment, hours, physical demands)

Salary & Benefits (Average salary, benefits, job outlook)

Required Qualifications (Degrees, certifications, skills)

Growth Potential (Future-Proof? % growth from BLS if available)

How It Matches My Interests, Skills, & Values (Personal Fit 1-5)

Practicality (Feasibility based on education, salary needs 1-5)

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.
- 4.
- 5.

Chart Reflection (10-15 minutes): After completing the chart, answer the following:

- Which occupation best aligns with my interests, skills, and values? Why?
- Which occupation scored highest in "Practicality"? What makes it a realistic option (e.g., salary, education)?
- What are the key factors that influenced my ranking of these careers?
- Are there any careers I want to remove from consideration based on this chart? Why?

Section 5: Overall Evaluation and Action Plan

Goal: Synthesize your findings into a ranking of careers and actionable steps to continue your career exploration journey.

- **Top Career(s) to Explore Further (5 minutes):** Based on Section 4, list 1-2 careers you're most excited to dive deeper into.
 - Career 1: _____
 - Career 2 (optional): _____
- **Next Steps for Each (10-15 minutes):** Outline 2-3 specific actions to learn more about or prepare for these careers. Examples: "Take a free online course on Coursera for [skill]," "Shadow a professional in [field]," "Research local job openings on Indeed.com," or "Conduct an informational interview."
 - For Career 1:
 - Action 1: _____
 - Action 2: _____
 - Action 3 (optional): _____

- For Career 2 (if applicable):
 - Action 1: _____
 - Action 2: _____
 - Action 3 (optional): _____
- **Personal Commitment (5 minutes):** Write a short statement committing to one small action this week to advance your exploration. Example: "This week, I'll spend 30 minutes on O*NET researching [career] to confirm if the tasks excite me."
 - My Commitment: _____
- **Fun Reflection (5 minutes):** Imagine yourself in your top career 5 years from now. Write 1-2 sentences describing a "day in the life" moment that excites you. Example: "I'm a Graphic Designer presenting a cool logo to a client, feeling proud of my creativity."
 - My Vision: _____
- **Broader Reflection (10 minutes):** After completing this worksheet, take a moment to reflect on what you've learned about potential careers. Consider how this information might influence your educational planning and future career decisions.
 - Reflection: _____